



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE
June 2023

#6

COMING EVENTS

JUNE

- 1st Monthly Meeting
- 3rd Cent Coast W'shop
- 7th Committee Meeting
- 10th Sydney W'shop
- 21st Fairground Follies
- 24/25th Rose Cafe, Goulburn
- 25th Mid-North Coast Gathering

JULY

- 1st Cent Coast W'shop
- 2nd DMH Birthday Display
- 6th Monthly Meeting
- 12th Committee Meeting

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Unless indicated photos by Jenny Penman.

As soon as we got home from sailing, the suitcase was emptied into the washing machine; only to be refilled with clothes for the National Rally at Chateau Elan. We've learnt the way to cure the subtly pervasive 'Eau de Healey' perfume, that gets into anything and everything, is to put the suitcase into a large garbage bag before stowing it in the boot. It's not elegant, but certainly works, with the added advantage that should any rain penetrate the boot, it won't wet our clothes. A few short hours after arriving home at Terrey Hills we are in our '100' and driving north. Henrietta (the 100) has only recently been returned to us by The Healey Factory. This is our second long run and she is sailing along at the legal limit, and we are "topless" (Henrietta that is) enjoying the sunny weather, and the lovely smooth effortless performance of the car.

The Rally committee had agreed to meet at 'The Deck' restaurant for lunch on Monday so to 'enjoy' an extra day, finishing off all the necessary last-minute details before the attendees arrive, so we had decided to start on a positive note with a really nice Tapas lunch and delightful glass of wine before the work began.

It's not all work of course, so after filling the Rally bags we adjourned for a convivial dinner. This year about half of the attendees at the Rally decided to add an extra night, so there were quite a few of us to enjoy the very informal (i.e. totally unplanned) evening.

At 2pm Tuesday we are all set to receive guests at our registration desk at Chateau Elan. Colin Rule and Jim Phillips have made the



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PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Don't mention the slot cars

I would like to apologise to every member who received multiple (10, 12, 16) copies of the email promoting the slot cars event. Unfortunately, messages sent using our website take a little time to process what can sometimes be 198 emails. To the uninitiated user this might appear that the "send" button hasn't functioned and so try sending them again. The webmaster has been requested to provide better training or tender his resignation.

National Rally

Congratulations to the 2023 National Rally committee, plus helpers, for a successful national rally in the Hunter Valley. We received plenty of positive feedback from attendees and although numbers were greatly reduced from those that indicated and paid deposits early, there was still plenty of occasions to renew acquaintances as well as make new ones and a time



when many, many stories were related. As someone pointed out to me that some of these friendships extend for over 50 years. No doubt there will be other pages in this newsletter for you to get an insight as to what transpired.

To relate my own "oh no" moment from the Rally. I had just passed through Cessnock on the way home and the car stopped. As you know with older cars it is either fuel or electrical. As I was using the NRMA app to have them come and HELP, Peter Jackson from Victoria pulled in and after a few minutes reckoned that it was electrical and we sort of agreed

that the new guys in the NRMA wouldn't be able to fix it and it would be a tow job. The NRMA guy arrived about half an hour later and fortunately he was an older guy and after checking out the electrics determined that fuel, or lack thereof, was the cause. However, I'm pleased to confirm that Peter's assessment was correct as it was the electrics, but to the petrol pump that had come adrift. A new connection fixed the problem, and I experienced that feeling of relief as the motor fired up and I motored home happy.

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COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
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0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

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02 9319 2299
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Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
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penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the
Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the June 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I hope that everyone will find something of interest within its pages.

These words are on page 3 and if you have got this far without nodding off, you would know that the feature article in this month's Flat Chat Newsletter is on the National Rally held early May in the Hunter Valley. From all reports everyone who attended thoroughly enjoyed themselves, which of course means that the event was well organised by our Rally Committee. Congratulations and well done to them all.

Once again many thanks to Ian Richter for his update snippet on the restoration of his 100. Reading about his recent visit to a local tool shop brought a smile to my face as it is certainly something I can relate to.

So what's in this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter? After last month's give-away BJ7 I thought everyone would like to read about making a

Rally 3000. Model that is. Recently when Don Read was clearing his memorabilia in amongst it all was a plastic modelling magazine dating from 1998. I recall when it came out, but my copy has disappeared into history. I have been known to put together the occasional plastic fine scale model and I have enough to last the rest of my lifetime and the next and probably the one after as well. I am currently working on a 1:700 model of the WW1 British warship HMS Warspite which is quite mind clearing after looking at a screen all day. You will find the article starting on page 25.

Lots of social information in this issue including news from the Central Coast, Illawarra/Southern Highlands and Mid-North Coast Chapters. In addition there are previews of things to come. The sad news is that there are no minutes as there wasn't a May monthly meeting. However, there are lots of other things to enjoy. Thanks to Richard Horwood, Allan Whitehouse and

Bryan Levy for sending in photos that all will enjoy.

Why is it so that every time I work on the Quinn Austin-Healey a 'Why Is It So?' situation arises? I was fitting the starter solenoid which is located in a relatively easy to reach place compared with production cars. For some 'Why Is It So?' reason the cable from the battery wouldn't reach the solenoid. It's the same cable that's been on the car since it was restored during the 1980s and probably way earlier. The battery is in the same place, the engine position is no different and the solenoid is the same one. So I had to undo all the clips under the car and over the top of the rear banjo and move it along an inch or so. All fine, but it's a mystery.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Please if you are doing some work to your car or taking it for an enjoyable run, let your fellow members know by sending in a few words and perhaps a photo or two.



Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**

DONALD HEALEY BIRTHDAY DISPLAY DAY 2023



Please join us on Sunday **2 JULY 2023**

At the Bowling Green, Parramatta Park
(Located near the main entry at the corner of Macquarie & Pitt Streets Parramatta)
From 10am until 3.30pm

A barbecue lunch and soft drinks will be provided, just bring a chair and your car.

Donald Healey was born on 3 July 1898 and throughout his lifetime was involved with the development of Healey, Austin-Healey, Riley, Alvis, Triumph, Jensen, Humber, Nash, Invicta and Austin marques.

The Austin-Healey Owners Club would like to celebrate DMH's birthday with a gathering of many cars of the above marques as possible.

For further information, please contact Ross on 0408 465 547 or email us at enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au



Your membership fees are due on 30 June 2023

To maintain your membership, you are invited to make payment by 30 June 2023

The annual fee will remain the same as the previous years at \$100 for membership of up to two members. All members - full, family and associate fees are due, the exceptions are life members, honorary, patron or new memberships in the past three months as they are extended to 30 June 2024 or if you have already paid in the last couple of weeks (we have received a cheque for the 2024 fees this week). Note - if you fall into these last two categories you will not be sent a renewal invoice.

This year, to utilise our website and make the renewals easier, we will send a generic invoice loaded on the website by email to you all in early June. Note there will be no tailored invoice with your car's details as in past years. Please make your payment by EFT and use description on your payment of '24 SURNAME and/or your MEMBERSHIP NUMBER' and this will help us reconcile payments. Should you feel you would like to advise me that you have paid, please send me an email to membership@austin-healeynsw.com.au to advise so that your records are updated correctly. Payments can be made at a general meeting in June or July by cash, cheque or pay by credit card which will incur a small fee. You must be a financial member if your car is on Conditional Registration. Car details can be updated by you, please log on to the website and update them. We need to ensure that we utilise our website rather than keeping alternative registers as these all take time to update.

Membership Cards will be available online from the website shortly, once your current membership fee is paid. We will also have an online membership form available on the website shortly for new memberships. We are also looking at having membership payments made online through the website though

this will not be ready for the renewals due at 30 June 2023.

New members this month are Phil and Sheridan McCarroll from Roseville with a newly built Austin-Healey 100S Replica by Steve Pike with number plate 100S. If you attended the Hunter Valley National Rally.

The National Rally in the Hunter Valley was a great event and sorry that you missed it! Photos from the Rally taken by Jenny Penman are available to view on the website under the tab – hope you find time to view them!

2023 National Rally Photos

We also have the Square facility to pay for your membership, and we also have new regalia items including dress shirts, polo shirts and bucket hats of which many were sold at the April meeting and at the National Rally. So get in quick before they all go or place an order with Colin Rule.

Look forward to seeing you all at an event soon or the June general meeting. If you are unable to attend the meeting maybe you would like to ZOOM in!

Happy Healeying!
Christine Lyttle



Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com
 Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

Event: Central Coast Chapter Technical Day

Date: Saturday June 3, 2023
 Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday
 Address: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber
 NSW 2251
 Cost: Zero
 Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
 cake, biscuit, slice etc

Event: Oasis Outing

Date: Tuesday June 6, 2023
 Time: 10am
 Meet: Sydney Olympic Park Archery Centre Car
 Park, Bennelong Parkway, Sydney Olympic Park
 Visit: The Floating Forest & Shipwrecks of Home-
 bush Bay (short walk) & also the Brick Pit Ring walk
 (view from entrance or 550 metre walk).
 Lunch: Vikings Sports Club 35 Quarry Rd. Dundas
 Valley. Details: Les 9838 8063 or [mumspalace@
 hotmail.com](mailto:mumspalace@hotmail.com)

Event: Sydney Technical Day – Greg Strange Motor Mechanic

Date: Saturday June 10, 2023
 Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday
 Address: 117 Cleveland, Darlington
 Topic: Alan Beresford worked on the production line
 at BMC Zetland in the 1960s. While working there
 Alan placed an order for an Austin-Healey Sprite, a
 car he still owns today. Stories from the production
 line, the creation and build of Austin-Healey Sprites
 in Australia. History, knowledge and the inside
 information of Austin-Healey and BMC is hard to
 come by, so come along to hear first hand the stories
 from someone who was there and trusted the product
 enough to buy one himself.
 Cost: Zero
 Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
 cake, biscuit, slice etc
 Register: PLEASE register in advance to the above.

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters Fairground Follies

Date: June 21st, 2023
 Time 10am
 Address: 93 Kirkham Rd., Bowral.
 See Page 12 for more information.

Event: Overnight run to the Rose Cafe, Goulburn

Date: June 24/25, 2023
 Stay: Trappers Motel (Mercure) - suggested
 Brunch: Rose Cafe
 Visit: Saturday 24th - Goulburn Rail Heritage Mu-
 seum, 12 Braidwood Rd Goulburn. 1.30pm to be
 confirmed.
 Sunday 25th, 2pm - Garroorigang Heritage House
 209 Braidwood Rd Goulburn. Tour and afternoon tea
 \$25.
 Details: Venues will need to be booked. Convoy runs
 to Goulburn TBA. Suggested return drive to Sydney
 via Marulan, Bungonia, Nerriga and Nowra

AHOC Mid-North Coast Chapter Gathering

Date: June 25th, 2023
 Times: 9:15am – 12:00 Midday
 Address: 79 Barton Street, Croki
 Cost: Zero
 Bring: Something to contribute to morning tea, eg
 cake, biscuit, slice etc

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chap- ters

Date: 19th Jul: "Out of Bounds Event".
 Event: Tour of Western Sydney International Airport
 & Lunch at Wallacia Pub.

Date: 9th Aug: "South Coast Tour".

Event: JindyAndy Old Mill-Shoalhaven. Lunch at
 Pelican Rock Café Greenwell Point.

Date: 20th Sept: "A Long Lunch" Taralga.

The full name; "A Very Long Drive to have lunch at
 Taralga".
 Perhaps the Western Chapter from Bathurst could
 join us.

Date: 4th – 8th Sept: Painted Silos Tour

See page 18 for details.

**The June meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 1st at Strathfield Golf
 Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the
 bistro with your fellow club members.**

Chapter News



AHOC Central Coast Chapter Gathering
6th May

We did have our May Saturday morning workshop after all. Having the National Rally finish on the Friday I originally thought people would need a break but I was totally mistaken. I was bombarded with requests to hold our 6th of May workshop meeting.

So I did a quick ring around and eleven brave souls turned up. Ian and Ruth Rounsevell from the South Australian AHOC were staying with us, so it was good for them to see how our workshops operate. In this case lots of coffee, cookies and cake.

The morning's conversation also reflected on our very successful Rally. The morning's demonstration was on how to clean our cars with the waterless car wash called Dri Wash 'n Guard conducted by yours truly.

The attendees were, Ian and Ruth from SA in a 100, Garry and Julie Lee BJ8, Bob Ratcliff BJ8, Chris Jenkins 3000 MK1, Geoff Smith 3000 MK1, Larry Johns 3000 MK1 and Roger Ramsey along with Kerrie and myself BN2.

Our June 3rd workshop morning will be a coffee and lunch run to Cardiff to visit a classic race car workshop/mancave owned by Dennis Tobin. Journey time

from Ourimbah to Cardiff is approximately an hour and a quarter. All welcome.

For our Sydney members, stay on the M1 going past the Gosford turn off, take the Ourimbah exit just past the speed camera. Turn left at the roundabout and stop at the Ourimbah Rest Area on the western side of the expressway Ourimbah.

Try and arrive at Ourimbah by 9.30am. We will depart in convoy at 10am sharp. Print off the below map to 4 Joy St Cardiff via the very scenic Dooralong, Durren Durren, Mandalong Valley, Myuna Bay and on to Cardiff by 11.30 am.

Things to remember! Make sure you fill up with fuel before you leave home. Bring your cookies and cake to share, coffee as usual will be on tap. A sausage sizzle lunch will be provided on the day.

Hopefully this will be a really great day of touring through the northern end of the beautiful Central Coast and the Lake Macquarie area. All you have to do is to turn up.

With all that said and done, take care and Happy Healeying. Col and Kerrie Rule.

AHOC Central Coast Chapter Run to Cardiff

Saturday 3rd June 2023

Take Ourimbah exit down the hill just past speed camera.

Turn left at roundabout to go to Rest area and meet.

9:30am Arrive at Ourimbah Rest Area on west side of M1 freeway.

10:00am Leave Ourimbah Rest Area.

10:30am Pass through Doorlong

Enjoy the corners through Mandalong.

11:30am Arrive at Denis Tobin's mancave

Ourimbah Rest Area, Ourimbah NSW 225

Old Maitland Rd, New South Wales

Doorlong, New South Wales 2259

Durren Durren, New South Wales 2259

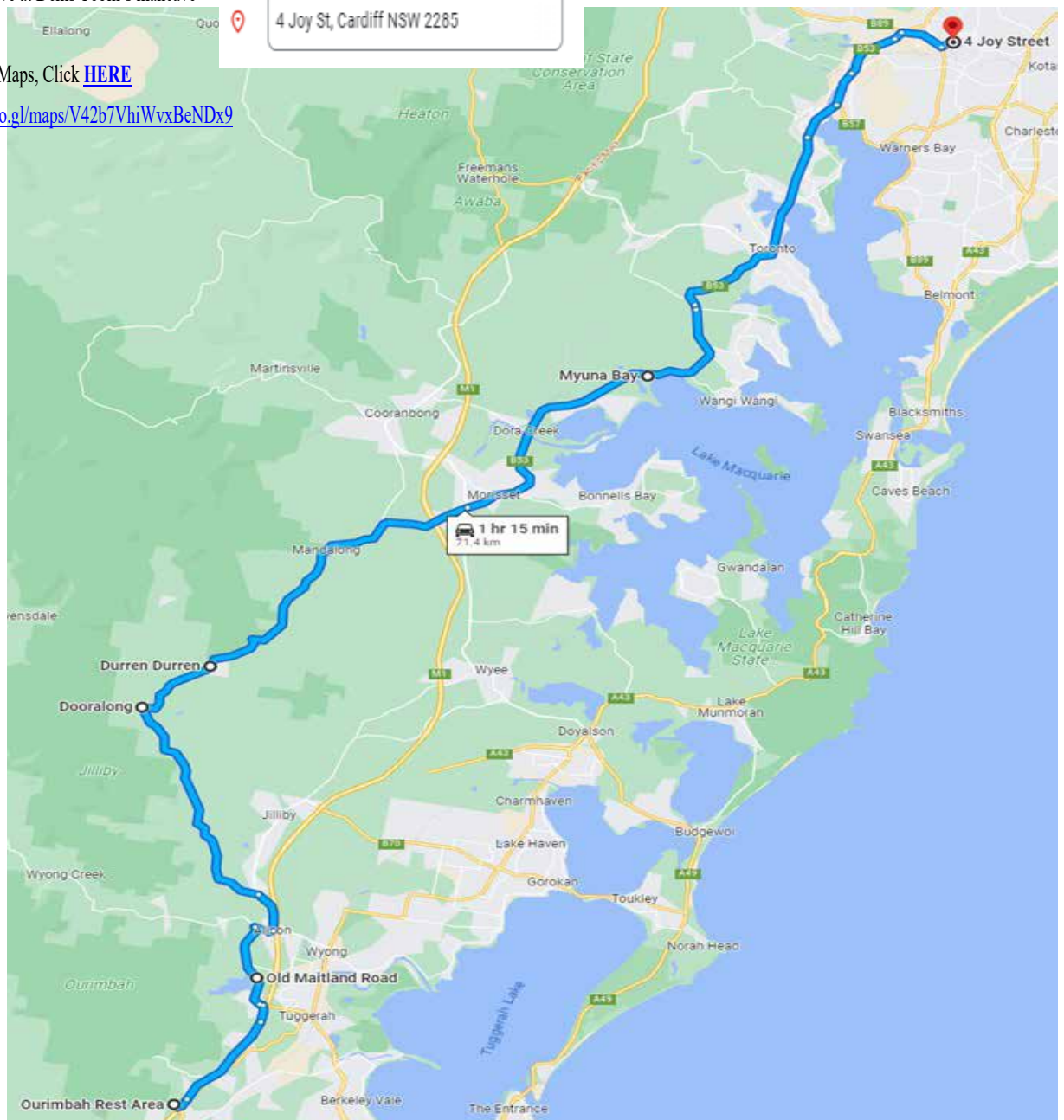
Myuna Day, New South Wales 2264

4 Joy St, Cardiff NSW 2285



To View in Google Maps, Click [HERE](#)

Or type in <https://goo.gl/maps/V42b7VhiWvxBeNDx9>



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

Wednesday 17th May 2023



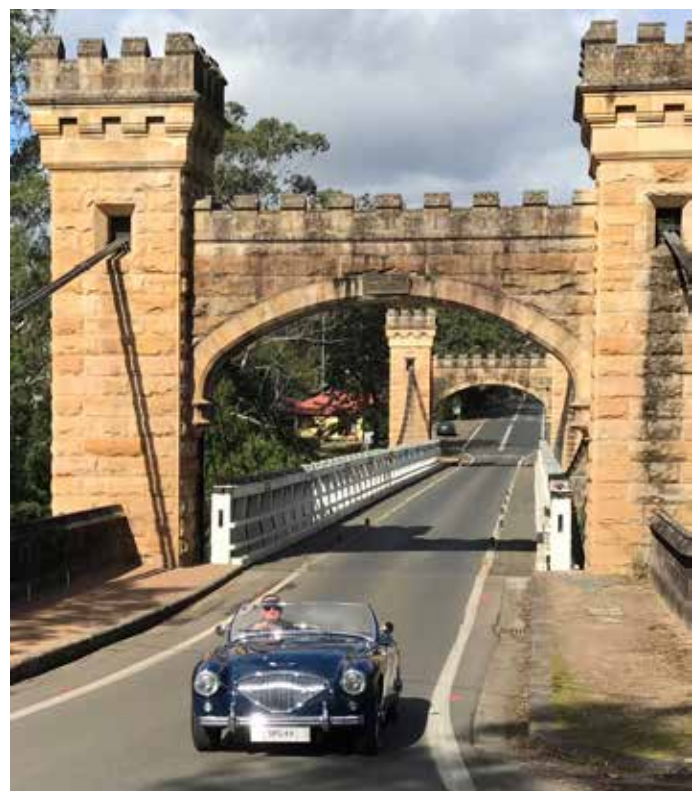
Our main photo tells you it is the right time of year to take a run in the Southern Highlands to experience Autumn. We picked the right day for our run to Kangaroo Valley where we enjoyed a beautiful lunch at The Friendly Inn.

The magic Autumn colours greeted us as we ventured into Kangaroo Valley.

The shops did not offer that usual attraction, once

we saw the perfect colours that nature bestowed- the scenery was a photographer's dream. There was no hesitation from AHOC members Gerry South and Rex Kilner, when Fran suggested we head off along the valley road and find locations to take photos of their Austin-Healeys.

When I planned this day into the Valley, my only idea was photographing Austin Healeys on the historic Kangaroo Valley Bridge. That soon changed.





Thank you to Gerry and Rex for their time allowing us to enjoy these photos.

After the photography expedition, we met up with Colin Goldsmith who decided to take a circular driving tour on the day by heading south along the Princess Highway and across from Nowra to Kangaroo Valley and then venturing home through Bowral to his home in the Hawkesbury.



Lunch was enjoyed at The Friendly Inn Hotel at Kangaroo Valley, and it lived up to its name with a very comfortable, warm dining room, with friendly staff and great food. After the usual chatter and fun, it was time to say goodbye till next time.

John Thornton

AHOC Mid-North Coast Chapter Gathering Saturday 27th May 2023

Unfortunately, the flu virus is raging on the Mid North Coast.

Our proposed discussion and lesson on the many uses of a multimeter had to be moved to next month's meeting, as Chris Hatch fell victim to the flu, as did Tony Ash, so the balance of the members will have to wait to see Tony's new 3000 Mk2 Roadster acquisition.

The balance of the group had a lengthy morning tea of scones and cream while discussing many and varied problems related to maintaining and restoring our Cars.

Our next meeting is scheduled for the 25th June in Croki.

Phil Lorking

President's Message cont'

Hybrid Meetings

As I've been threatening over the past few months, we will attempt a hybrid meeting on Thursday 1st June and I'm hoping that many of you who are unable to join the general meeting on Thursday will dial in. In advance I need to indicate that this is a new experience for me and therefore not sure how

it will turn out so ask for your indulgence as well as your feedback as to how it can be made more enjoyable.

You will have received a link to the hybrid meeting with the email that came with this issue of Flat Chat.



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

It's gone so quickly. Tomorrow will be June, which makes me wonder what happened to the year so far. Soon we will be told the number of shopping days to whenever. Oh dear!

What it does mean however, is that we are coming to the end of the AHOC membership or financial year and soon you will receive an invitation from our Membership Secretary to re-join for 23/24, which we all hope you do.

While this is significant enough, it is even more so if you have a car conditionally registered through the AHOC. Why is this so? Said the professor with fuzzy hair. Well one of the conditions prescribed by Transport for NSW

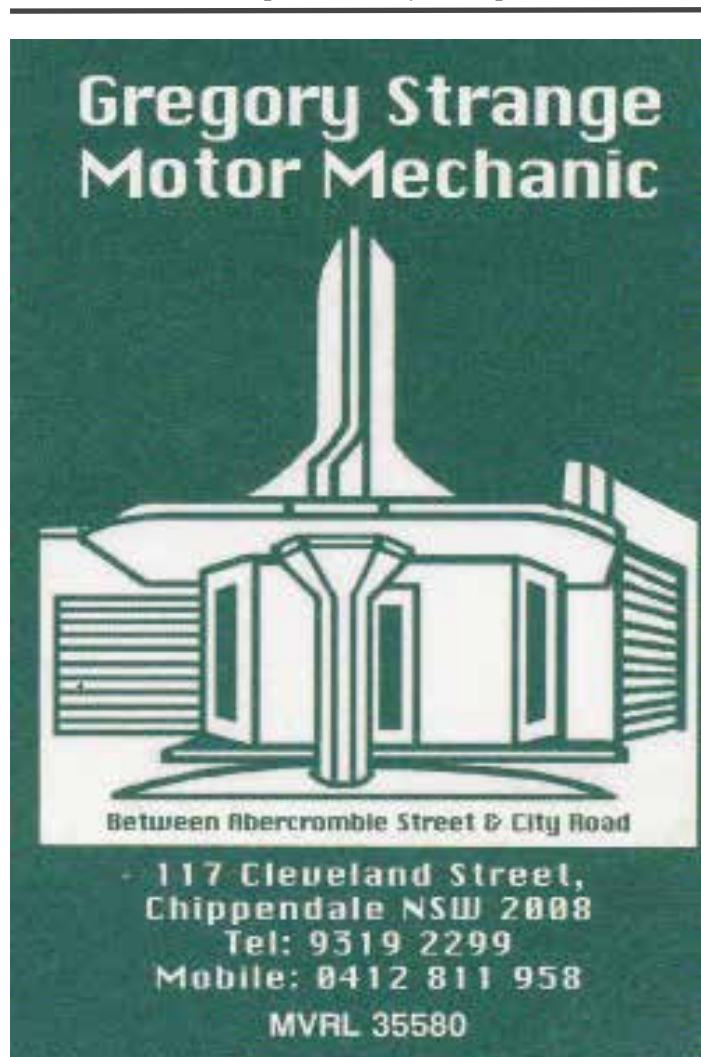
to have your car conditionally registered is that you must belong to a recognised car club, which the AHOC is. If you don't belong to a recognised car club, your Conditional Registration vehicle ceases to be registered. So if you don't renew your AHOC membership, your vehicle is no longer registered and it doesn't matter if you had re-registered your car not long beforehand. You may however have joined another recognised car club and informed Transport for NSW, meaning that your registration remains current. That's quiet okay.

So please when you receive your membership renewal, remember your registration as you can imagine the problems you could have with the constabulary and your insurance provider if you are driving an unregistered vehicle.

Also please don't forget that if you use your vehicle for a non-club event make the entry in the logbook. In fact if in doubt, fill it out.

Again, the necessary renewal steps are indicated below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

AHOC ILLAWARRA AND SOUTHERN HIGHLANDS CHAPTERS

BOOK NOW!!!

21st JUNE

FAIRGROUND FOLLIES



Do you want to re-live your youth? **YES, YES, YES!!**, I hear you say.
Come with me and I will have you re-living your "Childhood"
from the minute you walk into this amazing private collection.

YOUR FRIENDS ARE WELCOME

FULLY OPERATIONAL HISTORIC FAIRGROUND EXPERIENCE

- This event is a two-hour tour of the entire historic exhibition, with morning tea.
- Payment to: AHOC of NSW. BSB 032 669 Ac 252 564
Please Include your Name and Event ID: FOLLIES
\$38.00 per person

CLOSING DATE for Booking and Payment is 14th June 2023.

Also, please send me an email confirming your attendance.

Time: 10:00 Start. Please arrive early.

Address: 93 Kirkham Road Bowral in the industrial area. West side of Railway Line. Located between The Bowral Brickworks and Reece Plumbing warehouse. There is parking on the site for approx. 12 Austin-Healeys. Further parking is on the road outside the property.

After the tour we are heading to the Sutton Forest Inn for lunch. Let me know if you are considering lunch, so I can give the Inn a "heads up" on numbers. Thank you all.

John Thornton:

Mobile: 0419 266 284 Email: john.thornton2011@outlook.com

Rally cont'



most of the tiny corner of the reception area that the hotel had somewhat grudgingly allowed us. We had been promised more, but safety rules and access requirements meant that what had been promised could not finally be delivered. However, the great thing about this is that our guests had to queue to register right alongside the regalia stall. As all NSW members know, Colin is a master at encouraging people to buy our magnificent regalia and Austin-Healey themed items and he did not disappoint. He had of course stocked up on some really nice shirts in different colours and styles amongst a great selection of books, memorabilia, etc, etc. Colin was busy, and many guests left for their rooms sporting that special little purchase that goes to make rallying so enjoyable, in my case a couple of shirts.

Later that afternoon, Jim Phillips and I hosted the National Delegates' Meeting, and later the AAAHC AGM. As had become accepted practice during Covid, both meetings allowed delegates to join the meetings by zoom. Unfortunately, what we didn't know was that the Hotel's Wifi doesn't work very well. In fact, five minutes before we were due to start the first meeting, the Hotel's internet link disappeared, never to return. WiFi was fine, but we just weren't connected to the Internet anymore. Eventually we re-established Zoom contact after more than a little muffled cursing and finally using a mobile phone as a hotspot. And so, the meetings proceeded. All went swimmingly, until my phone data allowance ran out! That was the end of Zoom for those at the Rally, but of course all the remote attendees were still connected to each other. We ended up having a phone conversation between the meeting room and David Hillier who relayed the proceedings to

the remaining zoomers. And they say technology is so easy to use ... Anyway, all's well that ends well, which it did.

Delegates

The satisfactory conclusion of the meetings left the delegates finally free to join the fun of Tuesday evening's informal "Meet your friends old and new" where we queued patiently for a glass of wine, beer, or soft drink while Hotel staff worked out what they ought to be doing. With a little help from our Bruce Ewan, who knows about these things, they did eventually settle into an effective routine and people mingled and chatted. We decided to dispense with welcoming speeches and such-like as all that anyone needed to know was in our beautifully produced and interesting Rally booklet. This of course allowed more time for socialising, eating and drinking. The waitstaff efficiently distributed food and drink around the throng of guests and the chatter grew louder as the evening proceeded. It was getting a little cool in the evenings at this time of year, but the Hotel had lit a huge fire pit where many of our guests took up residence in comfy chairs for the rest of the evening.



Wednesday dawned bright and clear. There was a light dew on our car, so I took advantage to give Henrietta a quick bath before we headed off for Hunter Valley Gardens and our display morning. Over 60 Austin-Healeys were in attendance including Robbie Rowland's beautiful new 100/6 creation. It had me seriously dreaming of buying it, should it ever come up for sale. Not to be outdone, Peter Rowland had his extraordinary wide-bodied



Austin-Healey with what I will call an E-type bonnet, which gives ease of engine access that other Austin-Healey owners can only dream of. I was thinking of calling it a 'Triumph Herald bonnet', but that would have been a tad disrespectful, for this gorgeous descendant of an Austin-Healey. Then there was Colin and Kerrie Rules 'new' 100 BN2, reminding of how our cars were when new from the factory, except the quality of Colin's rebuild is way above anything the factory ever produced. Add to that Geoff Smith's Mk 1, George and Liz Goodare's 100M and some lovely inter-state visitors we were treated to a glorious selection of beautiful beasts.

We were also graced by four cars from the Hupmobile club: two Hupmobiles, an Essex and a Maxwell. (The original Smart car?) Each of them was immaculately turned out and created a great deal of interest. I almost felt sorry for the sole Ferrari and an immaculate Jaguar Mk 2, as everyone walked past them to look at our veteran visitors.

The only slight disappointment was the display location. As it was a little out of the way it did not attract much attention from the 'public'. While the Hunter Valley has much to offer, one thing that it seems to lack is an obvious public venue for car displays. Your Rally committee looked long and hard and AquaGolf was the best we could find.



Wednesday Afternoon

Wednesday afternoon was free time for guests to lunch, visit wineries, or take in a historic town or museum. Louise and I enjoyed a leisurely afternoon lunching at The Deck in company with a few other Austin-Healey owners.

'Party Night' began with a delicious dinner – two courses followed by cheese and biscuits. Then the band, Bad Sneakers, struck up! The music was so infectious that within a minute or two the dance floor was full, and Louise and I were dancing on the carpet. That was the pattern for the rest of the evening. 'Bad Sneakers' played great dance music from the '50s, '60s and '70s, but not so loudly that people couldn't chat. Kerry Milner took the microphone for an impromptu song that was loudly applauded, then the dancing carried on. All in all, it was a fantastic party night.

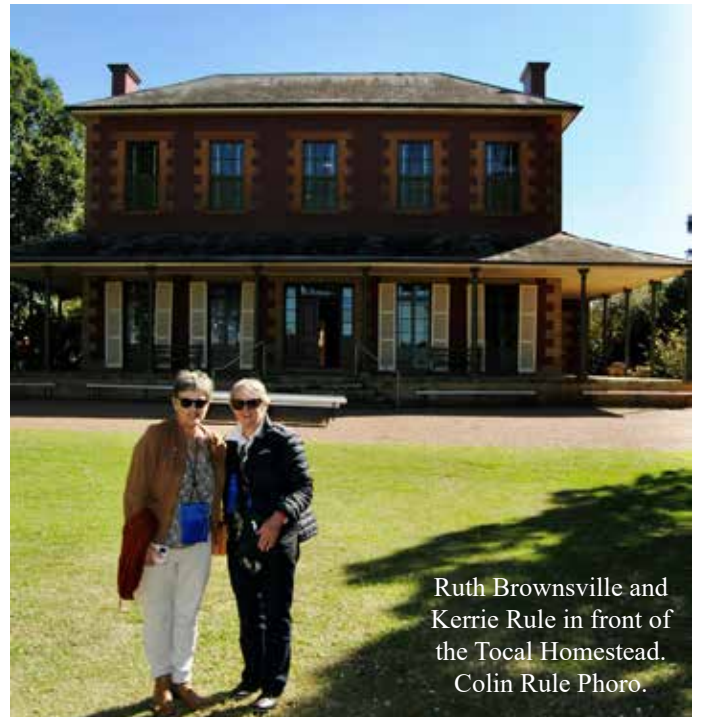


Somewhat surprisingly after the party, early breakfast was well attended before we all headed off to Tocal Homestead. We took the country route via Branxton and Elderslie which saw a stream of beautiful Austin-Healeys cruising through pretty, rolling country. It was **SUBLIME!**



Tocal Homestead is a heritage listed homestead and farm complex dating from the 1820s that due to some inexplicably strange notions of former owners has managed to survive. It is an amazing time capsule, from the convict built stable, to what must have been a very comfortable home. The house is framed by gigantic fig and banyan trees and stands on a hill overlooking the farmlands. Our guide, Sandy, told us its history, pointed out many interesting features

including a few surprises, such as aboriginal sharpening grooves in a rock, a timber barn based on a church design, and a 1920's Rolls-Royce in the garage, complete with service record handwritten on the wall. We finished our tour with sandwiches, slices, and fruit, all provided by the Homestead's band of volunteers. Having toured the Homestead, I can well understand why people are prepared to donate their time and energy to its preservation. If you haven't been, add it to a visit to the Hunter – you won't be disappointed.



Ruth Brownsville and
Kerrie Rule in front of
the Tocal Homestead.
Colin Rule Photo.



Rally Cont'

Two days, almost done and it was time for the Gala Dinner. No music for this one, just deliciously enjoyable food and wine with good conversation around the tables. It is customary at each National Rally to make some awards and this one was no exception. Recently Colin Rule's '100' had been judged and found to be almost perfect (it had a couple of oil leaks) and was scored 98 out of a 100 for originality. That is a massive achievement and John Kent took pleasure in presenting the Concours Gold Award to Colin. The judges were also presented and commended as is it not an easy or quick task to inspect every aspect of a car and judge each against a written standard. One other trophy that is awarded at the National

Rally is the Alan Jones Trophy, or more correctly the 'Australian Austin-Healey Owners Club Perpetual Trophy for Best Performance in Club Activities'. It was a surprising and wonderful honour to be this year's recipient and I thank the Clubs for selecting me and I thank all of my Austin-Healey colleagues in the various clubs who give us all so much pleasure.

George and Sandra Pickering were awarded the 'Good Sports Trophy'. Sandra then continued, telling us about Ian Wookey, who had made strenuous efforts to recover his health and make the journey to the Rally from WA. He and Jan Dunstan were very appropriately awarded the 'Hard Luck Trophy', although to my mind it ought to be the renamed the 'Spirit and Determination Award' in this case.

The final part of the presentations was also left to Sandra who showed us the beauties of WA in wild flower season and invited us all to join the WA club at Geraldton in August, for the 2024 National Rally.

That was the 2023 Austin-Healey National-Rally that was.

See you all at Geraldton next year.

Gordon Lynas

Happy Rallyer (and Chair of the Rally Committee)



Peter Jackson (L) and John Kent (R) presenting Colin and Kerrie Rule with the Gold Award.



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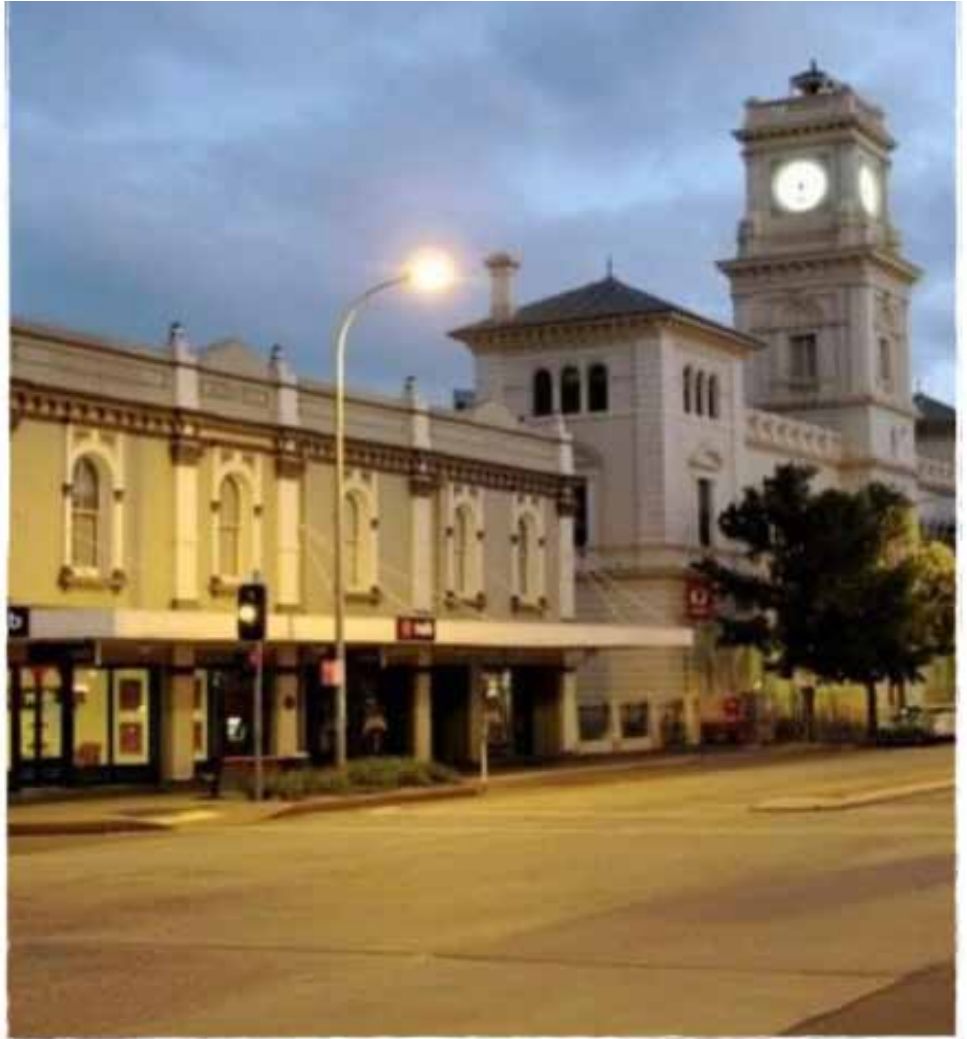


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JUN
24



GOULBURN VISIT

Sat 24 June, option to visit Goulburn Rail Museum, stay overnight. Sunday 25 June, Brunch at Rose Cafe 11am, followed by visit to Garroorigang Heritage House RSVP Denis Kasza 0407492008

PAINTED SILOS TOUR - 4th to 8th September 2023 - Itinerary

Monday - SEPTEMBER 4th

Depart Sydney
Travel to HARDEN MURRUMBURRAH
Silo location – Neill Street, Harden

Continue to GRENFELL

Silo location – 30 West Street, Grenfell

Continue to WEST WYALONG for overnight stay at either:-

CAMEO MOTEL, 263 Neeld Street, \$120/night, 6 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2255

Or

COLONIAL MOTOR INN, 4 Ungarie Road, \$ 130/night, 10 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2611

TOTAL 530 KMS FOR DAY



Grenfell



Harden



Weethallie

Tuesday - SEPTEMBER 5th

Depart West Wyalong to WEETHALLIE

Silo location – Railway Street, Weethallie

Continue travel on to DUBBO for overnight stay at

BLUE DIAMOND MOTOR INN, 113/115 Wingewarra Street, \$150/night, 10 Queen, 5 Twin rooms

Phone (02) 6882 0666

TOTAL 380 KMS FOR DAY



Dunedoo



Quirindi



Merriwa

Wednesday - SEPTEMBER 6th

Depart Dubbo to DUNEDOO

Silo location – Castlereagh Highway, Dunedoo

Continue to MERRIWA

Silo location – Hackets Road, Merriwa

Continue to QUIRINDI via SCONE

Silo location – Quirindi

Overnight stay at BEST WESTERN MOTEL/RSL, \$148/night, two people

Phone (02) 6746 1995

TOTAL 340 KMS FOR DAY



Barraba



Gunnedah

Thursday - SEPTEMBER 7th

Depart Quirindi to BARRABA,

Silo location – Manilla Road, Barraba

Continue travel to GUNNEDAH

Silo location – 2 Barber Street, Gunnedah

Overnight stay at the HARVEST LODGE MOTEL, 404 Conadilly Street, \$160 for night, 2 people

Phone: (02) 6742 3400

TOTAL 260 KM FOR DAY

Friday - SEPTEMBER 8th

Depart Gunnedah to PORTLAND

Silo location – William Street, Portland

NO MOTEL ORGANISED, SOME MAY WISH TO TRAVEL HOME.

IF NOT, BOOK A MOTEL

TOTAL 350 KMS FOR DAY TO PORTLAND



Portland

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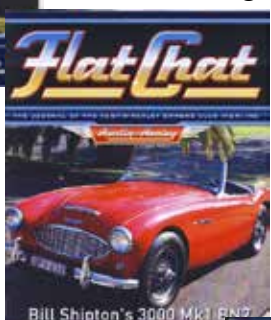
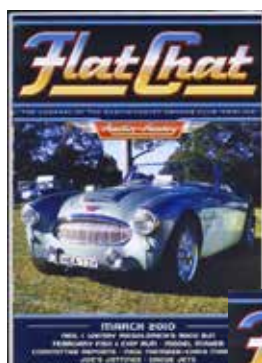
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stamp) at a meeting.



The Project - Snippet Two

By Ian Richter

Three steps to success.

One. Ensure that you have a vague idea of what you are trying to achieve with the restoration, and ensure you have enough tools for the job.



Two. It is paramount that you use every conceivable tool you own for the restoration project. Tools have this remarkable ability to disappear as soon as they leave your fingertips. I have resolved this problem by carelessly spreading all my tools across the shed floor and benches for easy access to that one tool you are searching for. If this doesn't work, make sure you have duplicates and spread these around also.

Three. There is always that one tool you think will make your job easier, and it's a must-get-it situation. Well, I think a few of us have slipped down this rabbit hole more than once.

Tool requirements can be a dangerous game. This is not made any easier with the plethora of tool shops popping up in every suburb. The lure of the wonders contained inside with rows and rows of twinkling charms that entice you in for a look. "Oh. There's the tool store, I need a few flap discs, I will only be

a few minutes," I say, passing by on our way to a family lunch.

As you enter the tool store, you pass the store gatekeepers in red company shirts sitting on tall chrome-legged stools behind the long counter. There is a nod of acknowledgement as you enter. There is no "Can I help you?", it's not how this works. The tools hang like jewels on their hooks. Up and down the rows you wander, searching out your items. This time I got out lightly. I leave the store with a few flap discs, a new punch set and an additional 18-volt battery as backup support for the five I already have and a pair of wire cutters from the bargain bin.

It's like time stands still when you enter the store. I'm sure I was only five minutes. The realisation of time passed doesn't hit home until the automatic glass doors close behind you. As a veiled attempt to disguise your hoard, you pop the car boot and load in your treasures. Little is said as you continue your journey, but I can feel the annoyance from Jennifer, who has been waiting (not so patiently) in the car for the past twenty minutes. If only I had stuck to the plan.



Project cont'

The work continues on the BN1's chassis. Many years of 'who cares if the chassis scrapes over obstacles?', and 'who is going to see it anyway?' attitudes have left quite a few dents for repair to the chassis underside. I burrowed a tool for the chassis repair. This tool cannot be purchased in some fancy tool store. This old worn tool, no, experienced tool, has been called into action for years and on many Austin-Healey resto projects.

It has no name, but I'm calling it the Chassis Seam Puller or CSP for short. It's two old pieces of steel welded together and forms an adjustment tool. It works extraordinarily well, even in the hands of an amateur. I have spent many nights pulling the chassis seams into alignment. Welding on the CSP, levering up the seam and grinding the CSP off. Then repeat and repeat. I am almost there.

these in place, back in nineteen fifty-four had a contemptuous attitude, carelessly firing off a spot weld every quarter inch or so. Nothing is in line, just spot welds everywhere.



I'm fairly certain over the years, I have collected enough tools to complete this restoration. As a lad, I would borrow tools from my father, few were returned. I still have these tools and continue to use them. He never complained or asked for their return. I would like to think it was his way of encouraging me to use my hands. I do wonder if my sons or daughters will ever see the importance of my tools or use them in the way I have. Time will tell.

Until the next update, Ian.



Just for something different to the chassis work, I have started on replacing the rear bumper outriggers and inner boot boxes. It started out as a repair, but the deeper I dug, the worse the rust became. I would have preferred to have kept the original boot boxes, but it is impossible to replace the completely rusted through outriggers and repair the rust in the back chassis gussets with the boot boxes in place. The boot boxes were held on with an unbelievably large number of spot welds. I'm guessing whoever put



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Thank You for Coming – Enjoy Your Time in Berry

Thank you to Richard Horwood for sending in these photos taken at the National Motoring Heritage Day at Berry Showground on Sunday 21st May.

While there are Austin-Healeys, Richard was at pains that that the photo of his mighty Chrysler Valiant GLX Sports Sedan with the 318 V8.....aka The Tomato Sauce bottle or "BIG RED"....gets a mention. I am told that it's a very rare car.



An unknown 100/6 - any takers?



Gerry South and his 100.

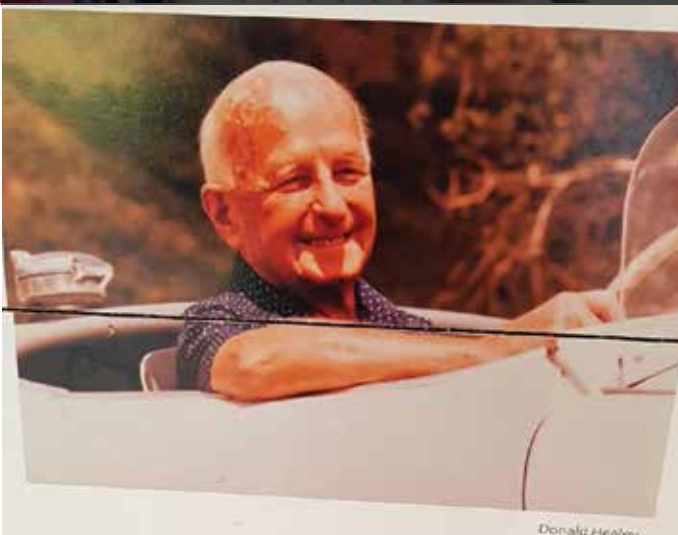


The BN6 of Greg Barnsley



Thanks to Bruce Ewan for sending these photos from London.

Remember the Caton Healey? The first three photos Bruce took at the Saville Row Concours, the fourth was not.



Donald & Ivy Healey Owned Trebah 1961-1971

In 1961, Trebah was bought by racing driver and car designer Donald Healey (1898-1988) and his wife Ivy (1893-1980). Over the next ten years they removed much of the concrete from the beach and built the existing boathouse with granite which had been used as hardcore on the beach.



Thanks to Allan Whitehouse for the DMH photos sent to him by a friend who was visiting the UK.

On the right is an Alfa Romeo engine powering a 100/6. Thanks to Bryan Levy for the photo.



CHARLIE'S RUN 2023 2024

By this time of year, you would normally have a Charlie's Run to consider joining. This year I'm afraid will be an exception. For one reason and another I haven't managed to arrange anything for 2023.

However, all is not lost! Terry Bancroft's Painted Silos Tour on 4th – 8th September will give you all the opportunity for almost a week away with your Austin-Healey (even if it is a BJ9). It would be great to get a line up like this one with a silo mural in the background!



Next year the National Rally will be held at Geraldton WA from 22 to 26 August, which as you can see below looks very inviting.



(Photos courtesy of the Ocean Centre Hotel)

Because the 2024 National Rally won't be around Easter, it leaves a gap in the Austin-Healey calendar which I propose to fill with the **30th Charlie's Run**. My current plan is to travel west as we went north last year, south-west in 2021 and South to Merimbula in 2020. Bathurst, Parkes, Mudgee/Gulgong, and Oberon/Lithgow are on the draft itinerary to be visited between 16 and 22 March 2024. November's *Flat Chat Newsletter* will have full details, but do reserve this week in your calendar. It's going to be fun.



Happy Healeyng, Gordon.

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Auto Modelling Feature

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Austin Healey Conversion

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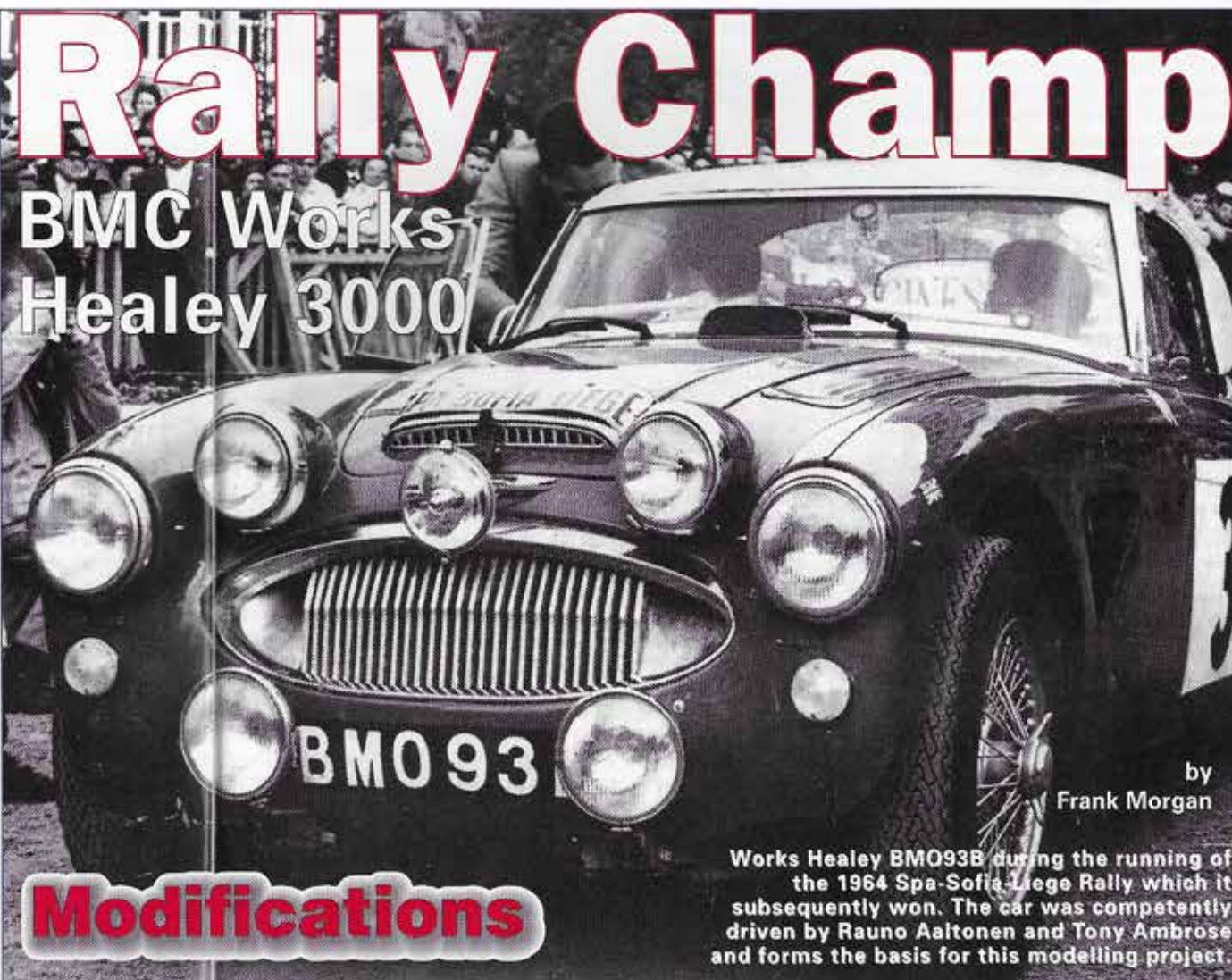
Aircraft
• **Reich Defender in 1/72**
• **Czech Swallow Ptl**

• **Accurate's
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• **Cavalier's
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Revell's age old Austin Healey kit of the sixties is given more than the 'once over' by master modeller Peter McKinnon. The result is a superb replica of an example of a the BMC Works Healey 3000 rally car which won the Spa - Sofia - Liege Rally in 1964. In this article Peter tells us how he went about this amazing transformation.

The Rally Healey

The English love affair with the big Healeys of the early sixties was not con-

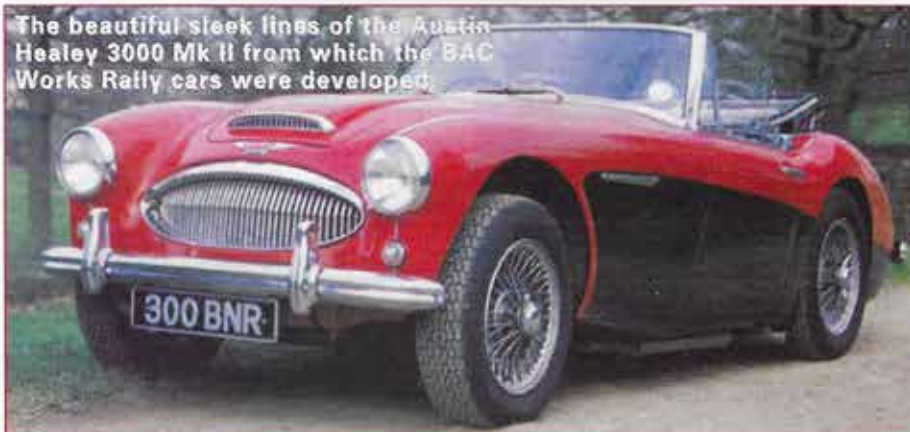
fined to the road. Several of these popular big cars found their way onto the race tracks of the day as well as into some of the top European rallies of the time proving more than competitive when in the competent hands of many of the top works drivers. One such vehicle was BM093B, an Austin Healey 3000 Mk III which was built up to rally specifications for the BMC (British Motoring Corporation) Works team in the early sixties and which was to win the 1964 Spa -

Liege Mountain Rally in the capable hands of Swiss rally ace Rauno Aaltonen and Englishman Tony Ambrose.

The car began life as a 1964 Healey 3000 Mk III which was virtually the top of the range Healey of the time being powered by the reliable Austin 2912cc engine. In road trim this car was good for 148bhp at 5250rpm which propelled it along at a top speed of 121mph. This vehicle was modified considerably for the competition tasks ahead, the modifications including a complete workover of the engine including a special triple Weber arrangement which replaced the old twin SU carburettor set up as well as other modifications to the suspension plus the addition of what appears to be a multitude of driving lights to the front of the car.

The Kit

The original Revell moulding of the Austin Healey 3000 first appeared in 1963 when it was released as a part of a series of 4 sports cars including a Porsche 356 Speedster, E-Type Jaguar, and an early model Corvette. The kit was quite well



detailed for its time but featured those horrible vinyl tyres that were moulded in two halves and were very difficult to stick together (these were pre Superglue days).

It was about 20 years before the kit was to see the light of day again being re-released under the Matchbox label in the early to mid 1980s. Just recently it has reappeared in its early boxing in one of Revell/Monogram's Selected Subjects Programme (SSP) runs.

As alluded to in the introductory paragraph, a considerable amount of work has gone into this model to improve its authenticity and realism, a job that took Peter the best part of two years on and off. Considerable time was taken in carefully studying appropriate references and having decided on the exact vehicle. After assembling his many references he started with the body.

The Body

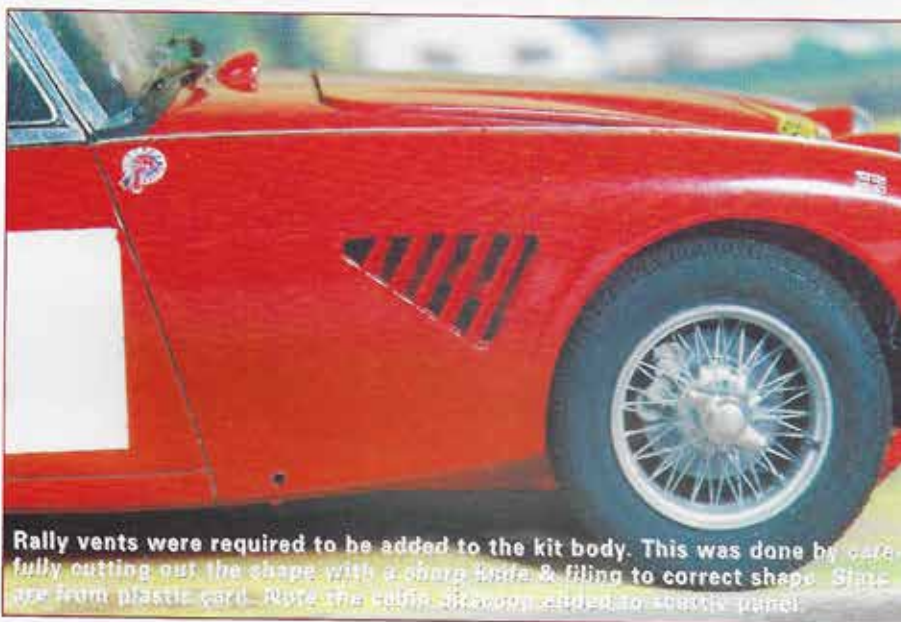
This was modified considerably from the original with a number of changes being made to the original body mouldings which in this kit, come in 4 pieces.

The rally vents that are such a noticeable item on the front guards of the car were designed to allow extra air flow and cooling of the engine, exhaust and brake systems. These were not a standard item on the road cars and therefore representation of these had to be made on the model. The vents were cut into the guards after careful measurement of their exact location was made from a photograph which just so happened to be exactly the same size as the scale model. After the positioning was carefully marked onto the moulding the vents were cut out after each corner was drilled and the shape cut out with a sharp hobby knife. The slats were added from pieces of plastic card.

A cabin air scoop located on top of the scuttle panel between the windshield and the bonnet was added after being moulded from plastic card and a small etched metal grille has been placed inside the scoop.

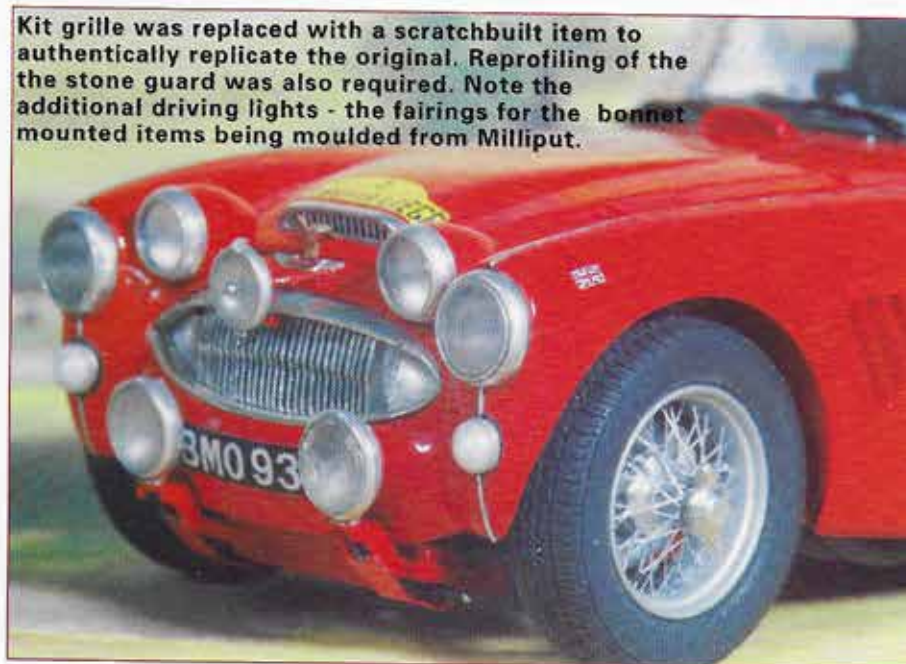
Turning his attention now to the front of the car Peter replaced the kit provided grille (which was the wrong grille for the model he was building) with a scratchbuilt item made from plastic strip and card. The surrounds and grille bars were covered in Bare Metal foil whilst the aluminium scoops either side of the grille were shaped from some aluminium roof flashing. Still working on the front of the car Peter deepened the stone tray as the model he was building needed to be fuller and not as shallow as that provided in the

Model has been substantially modified from the original with the project taking its builder two years to complete

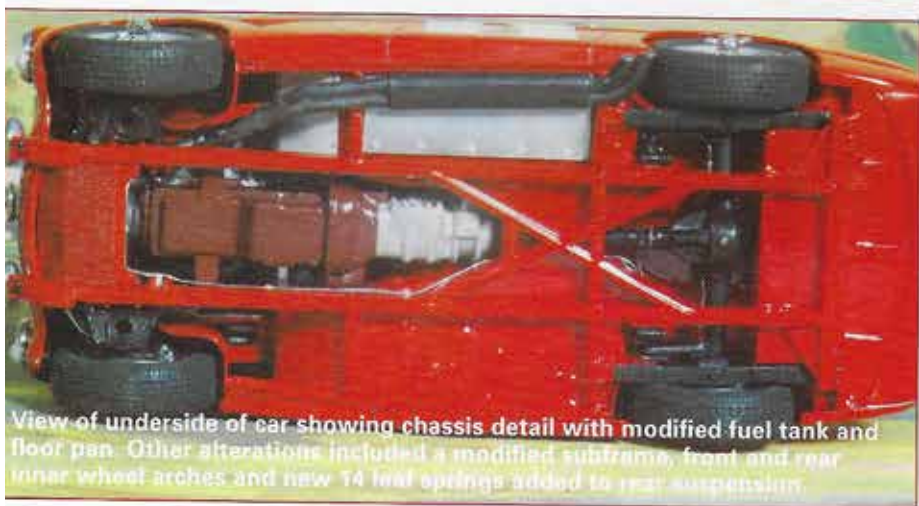
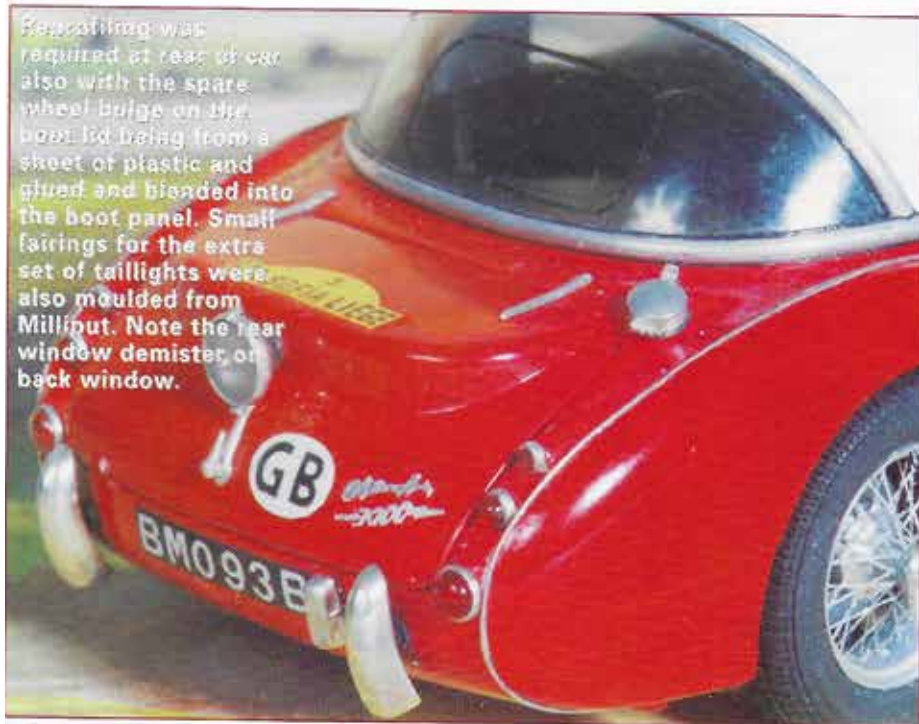


Rally vents were required to be added to the kit body. This was done by carefully cutting out the shape with a sharp knife & filing to correct shape. Slats are from plastic card. Note the cabin air scoop added to scuttle panel.

Kit grille was replaced with a scratchbuilt item to authentically replicate the original. Reprofiling of the the stone guard was also required. Note the additional driving lights - the fairings for the bonnet mounted items being moulded from Milliput.

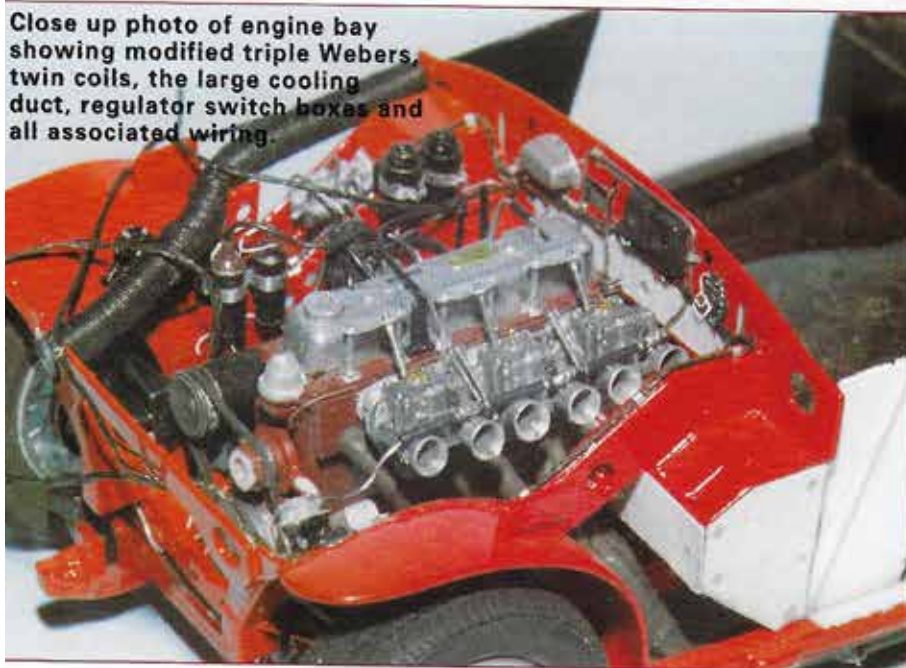


Reprofiling was required at rear of car also with the spare wheel bulge on the boot lid being from a sheet of plastic and glued and blended into the boot panel. Small fairings for the extra set of taillights were also moulded from Milliput. Note the rear window demister on back window.



View of underside of car showing chassis detail with modified fuel tank and floor pan. Other alterations included a modified subframe, front and rear inner wheel arches and new T4 leaf springs added to rear suspension.

Close up photo of engine bay showing modified triple Webers, twin coils, the large cooling duct, regulator switch boxes and all associated wiring.

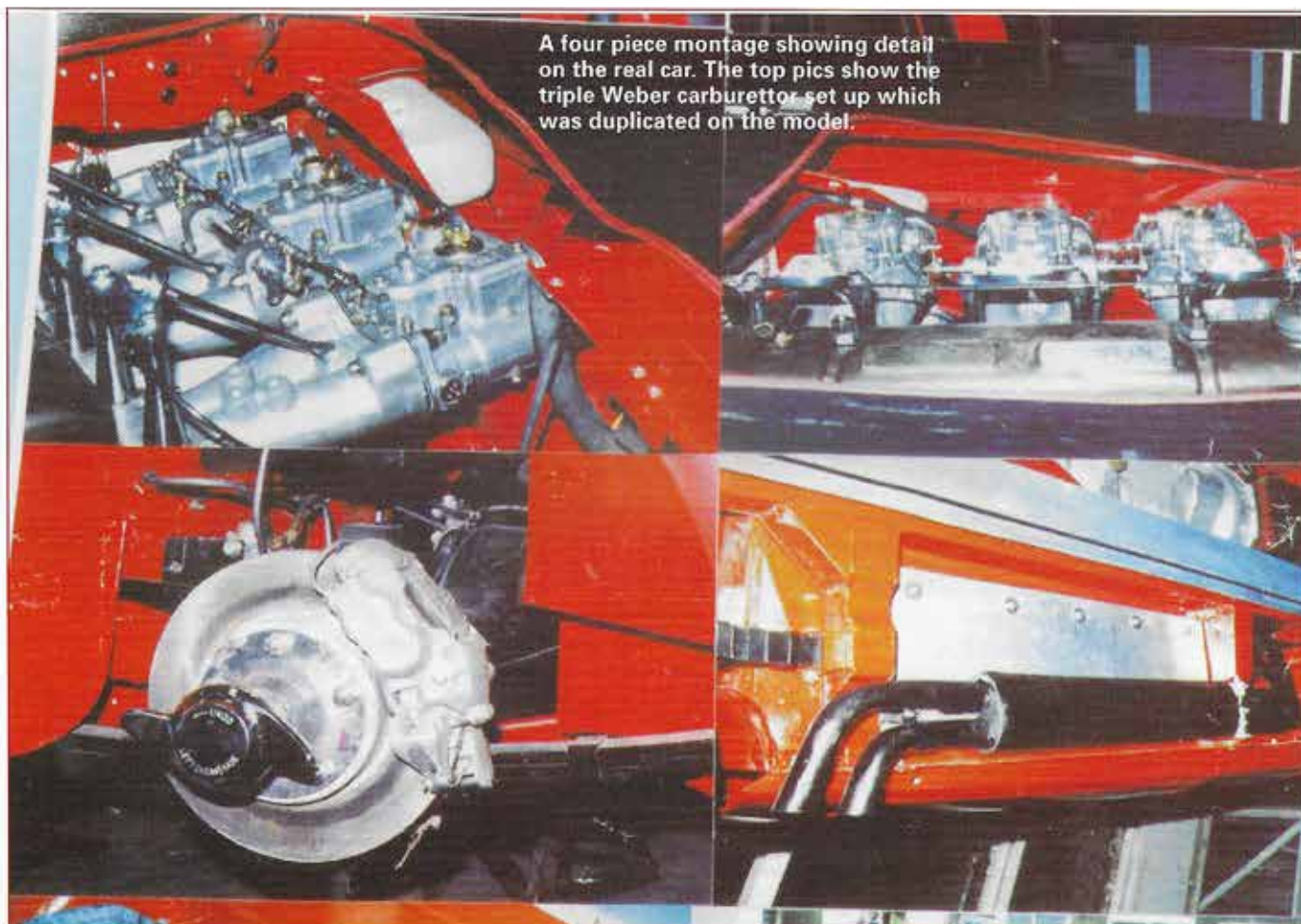


kit. This was done using a piece of plastic card for the extension and reprofiled using Milliput two part epoxy filler. At the same time the shroud between the grille and the bonnet opening was widened slightly also by the use of plastic card.

Some reprofiling was also required at the rear of the car to represent the spare wheel bulge in the boot lid - this being done by moulding a piece of sheet plastic to the right shape and gluing and blending it into the boot lid. Small central fairings located between the two standard tail light units on the rear guards were made from Milliput with these representing the extra set of tail lights that were fitted to these cars. Bumper bars were deleted from the car and their locating slots in the body were subsequently filled in with plastic card inserts.

A most noticeable feature of the front of these rally Healeys is the number of extra driving lights added - indeed five driving lights have been installed on this particular car. Successfully negotiating slippery mountain roads at high speed in the dead of night would be a good enough reason, especially for me. Having had some experience in this particular form of motor sport a long time ago in a galaxy far away (no, not in a Mustang!!) I can fully understand and appreciate the need for adequate lighting. Peter solved the problem of manufacturing a pair of lights that could be faired into the front of the car above the grille by again turning to Milliput - using this medium to mould the fairings. As these lights are an important feature of the front of the car, Peter expended a fair amount of effort to achieve realism in their presentation. As a result, all headlight and driving light rims are actually made from K & S aluminium tubing that have been 'turned' on a drill and polished up with Brasso. The actual reflectors inside the lights was made from aluminium flashing and held in place with two-part epoxy whilst the glass for these and the rear lights came from a Tamiya Rally Mini kit.

Other incidentals around the body of the car include the rear overriders which were moulded from plastic sheet and covered in burnished down dental foil, boot hinges, door handles and boot handles were made from cut down welding wire and polished, the fuel filler cap punched from some aluminium flashing, wind-screen wipers also from welding wire with plastic blades, the carburettor access door which is located on the left mudguard against the bonnet, made from plastic card with some wire ribbing and the trim



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Car was finished using 2-pack paint mixed to match the original Works Healey red. Four coats of both the red and white paint were applied. Racing numbers and most badges and logos were also painted.



moulding strips on the guards, made from fuse wire.

The hardtop roof is again moulded plastic which was made using a balsa wood former and it took Peter six attempts to obtain the correct shape with the rear window and windscreen made from the same moulding using acetate sheet. The windscreen trim moulding together with the side door frames and the vent frames are all aluminium flashing which has been

polished and glued into place using epoxy cement. The rear window trim moulding was made from some K&S tubing that had been sliced in half and appropriately polished.

The Austin Healey 3000 badge above the grille was made by pressing the kit badge moulding into some foil to obtain the outline of the badge and then pouring a small amount of resin into the back of the foil (after the kit moulding had been removed) to help reinforce the foil itself. The new badge with its polished foil covering was then added to the model in the correct place.

The bonnet grille was made from aluminium with fuse wire bars and aluminium flashing surround.

Chassis

Again this area was considerably modified from the original. The petrol tank and cabin flooring was all cut away from the chassis as these are significantly different on the real vehicle with the fuel tank

being a different shape and confined almost entirely to the boot area and the flooring assuming more of a dished shape. The modified floor pan was made from lead foil which had been glued over some reshaped plastic card. The exact shape of the floor and boot pans were made by cutting 10 thou plastic card to the exact patterns required. These shapes, which were cut separately were then glued to a piece of 15 thou plastic card with liquid cement and then overlaid with lead foil. These master plastic card shapes were impressed into the lead foil. The new lead foil pattern was then cut out and glued to the chassis with superglue. A whole new subframe was made from plastic card and included a modified fire wall (the kit provided item was the wrong shape). Front and rear inner wheel arches were moulded from plastic sheet and added to the subframe. A new front radiator support frame and cross member was built, again from stock and card with a pair of new 14 leaf rear springs (cut from strips of plastic card) together

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Photo showing boot interior detail including spare wheel, battery and connections and fuel filler pipe.





Peter McKinnon's Works Healey in all its splendour but we may have to wait another two years to see Peter's next project

with some Armstrong shockers made from brass tube also added. A lot of the suspension components such as the steering arms and tie rod ends were built up using brass. The anti-heat shield under the exhaust system was made up from aluminium flashing with the bolt patterns impressed into it by using a fine liner felt tip pen with the tip removed whilst the exhaust system itself was scratchbuilt from solder with a brass tubing muffler.

Engine

Revell's Jaguar SSK kit provided the Weber carburettor (somewhat modified from the original) that are in place on this car. These were moulded in resin in one piece complete with accompanying manifold. The kit provided engine block was used as is, as it is quite accurate. The carburettor throats were made from aluminium tubing and flared open at the top with a tapering tool. All of the engine 'add on' components such as the master cylinders and fluid reservoirs were made from either aluminium or brass. These cars were fitted with twin coils - one wired up as per normal and one along side as a spare. These were included in the engine bay and were made out of aluminium tubing with shaped resin tops. There is also a large cooling duct which was designed to take heat away from the engine bay - this being shaped not unlike a miniature air conditioning duct. This was replicated by wrapping a length of thick solder in some terylene black thread then applying some epoxy cement to hold the thread in place after the solder was removed. The resulting duct is most realistic in appearance.

Regulator switch boxes that are located

on the back of the firewall were all scratchbuilt from plastic scrap while the fuel bowl was made from a clear acetate moulding. Other additions to the block included the front fan pulleys cut from plastic sheet, generator from aluminium and oil filter from plastic tubing whilst the steering box also utilised plastic card and tubing and a brass steering column replaced the thin plastic original. All brake and hydraulic lines were made from fine solder wire and fine electrical wire found in pocket transistor radios. Wiring looms were twisted terylene thread. Radiator hoses were made from electrical heat shrink tubing.

Interior

The interior of this vehicle is indeed a true work of art being completely scratchbuilt with no kit parts used at all. Beginning with the instrument panel, Peter worked from a good photo of the instrument panel of the real car. Again using plastic card as his medium, Peter cut out two panels following exactly the shape of the original. The instrument dial apertures were cut out from the top piece whilst the second piece was painted in a thin coat of Tamiya flat black - just enough to cover the white plastic card surface. The first panel was then laid over the painted one and using a sharp scribing tool, the aperture circles were marked out - giving a 'white' ring. Using magnification, the details of the dials were carefully scratched in. A 40 thou depth spacer was then made and inserted between the two panels - this being followed by a piece of clear acetate (to represent the glass) was also inserted.

Instrument bezel rims were made from

very fine fuse wire and were very carefully laid around the edge of the circle on the first panel, superglued and then painted black (as on the real car). The whole instrument panel was painted in a wood-grain type finish - this done by dabbing and swirling various shades of brown with a brush. The toggle switches which replaced virtually all of the standard switch fittings on the dash were made from small pieces of flattened fuse wire and inserted into pre-drilled holes in the dash.

The steering wheel rim was made from brass wire bent around a former and soldered. The finger grip ribbings were reproduced by simply filing the required 'dimples' carefully into the back of the rim. The steering wheel spokes were cut out from 10 thou plastic card with the slots in the spokes being carefully eked out with a sliver of razor blade. The spokes were painted with Testors buffable aluminium with additional aluminium powder used to attain a very high polish.

Next added were items such as the hand brake lever, made from a piece of fine fuse wire encased in some aluminium tubing and the gear shifter, again made from fuse wire and sprue with some very small pieces of plastic card laminated and painted to represent the rubber gear lever boot. The horn button was also made from sprue.

The seats were built up from plastic card into a rough shape (a perfect shape was not required as they are to be covered). The seat cushion was built up using Blu Tac. The seat shape was then overlaid with some fine lead foil and the pleats and creases were marked in using a dental

probe. The result of this seemingly over complicated method of construction is a pair of extremely realistic seats. All seams were glued with superglue and the seat beading made with very fine solder again attached using superglue. The seats were painted using Humbrol Coal Black which was liberally brushed on and then continually stippled using a chisel edged brush until virtually dry with the result being a very realistic vinyl finish. All dash vinyl, door trims, parcel shelf and interior quarter panels were finished this way.

Doortrims were made using plastic card with the fine beading running along the top being made from sprue wrapped in lead foil and glued to the top of the door. Interior door handles, grab handles and window winders were made from aluminium wire shaped using pliers.

The roof has a head liner made from lead foil with the dash pad made the same way. The Halda Tripmaster was scratch-built from plastic card with sprue knobs and the two rear view mirrors (one for the driver and one for the navigator) came from optically flat plastic from a Barbie Doll mirror set with the rear surfaces painted black. Peter used a unique method in recreating the demister panel on the rear window. This was done by cutting the correct shape into some masking tape - the tape then being laid over the rear window. The shape was then sprayed with a few coats of clear varnish. When dry, the tape was removed leaving some very fine outlines which give the perfect impression of a rear window demister panel. The interior front windscreen demister suction cups were made using stretched sprue with the 'cups' being flattened at both ends carefully using a heated screwdriver - the bars were made from roof flashing and the connecting wires into the dash is fine fuse wire.

Seat belts were cut from computer printer ribbon cut to the correct width and brushed with a thin coat of PVA (tinted with dark grey) to prevent the ends fraying. Buckles were shaped from roof flashing as were the roof hold down brackets.

The interior is rounded out by the use of iron-on felt material on the floor to represent carpeting - this being coloured with the use of marker pens.

Wheels

The kit wheels were dispensed with completely and the search for suitable replacements was on. After some time Peter found that the Revell Mercedes SLR kit provided the right size and shaped rims he needed. He then respoked the

Scratchbuilt dash panel and modified steering wheel are shown here in this photo along with the 'home made' wire wheels and the modified body shell.



rims with nylon thread using the method described in *Plastics Modeller* No 36 (March April 1996) when building the Revell Vincent Motorcycle. Wheel and spokes were then sprayed dull silver using Humbrol Airframe Silver. The knockoff spinners were kit items that were refined by reshaping the blade part and covering them in dental foil (which is like Bare Metal foil only thicker). An American SATCO aftermarket set provided the Dunlop SP 9 tyres whilst the 4-wheel disc brakes were modified Detail and Scale items.

Painting and Finishing

The car was finished using 2-pack paint mixed to match the original Healey red for the body and off-white for the hardtop. The body was primed with a very fine coat of acrylic lacquer primer sprayed on virtually dry with an airbrush (if applied too heavily the lacquer would have crazed the plastic).

This was followed by four coats each of the red and white paint - sprayed on five minutes apart and allowed three to four days to dry thoroughly. Once dry the finish was sanded thoroughly with 1500/2000 grade wet and dry paper used wet and then polished using a Dremel polishing mop attachment on a slow turning drill setting and using Brasso as a polish. A final polish using 3M Hand Glaze polish finished the job off perfectly.

All racing numbers on the car were masked and hand painted with most badges also being painted. The number plate numbers and letters were taken from an 'M n J' railway set and the small Union Jack decals were mounted on small pieces of aluminium foil before being attached to

The hardtop roof was moulded plastic with trim moulding made from K & S Tubing.



the body.

After reading this article some may ask "Why did Peter go to so much trouble - I couldn't be bothered". Let's remember that modelling is a very personal and individual pastime and with this in mind, let's think about how we, as individuals, approach our hobby. Some of us are content just to sit down and build a model straight out of the box. Many of us don't have time to do anything else. Others want to delve into enhancements and modifications to varying degrees of complexity and a few, like Peter McKinnon, like to go 'the whole hog' It is their choice and I for one am very pleased that it is for it is examples of work from those like Peter McKinnon that, at shows, leave the general public with its mouth open in sheer admiration of the workmanship that goes into such a project - and this doesn't hurt our credibility one bit. Not only that it just makes our hobby so much more fascinating and inspiring.

Well done Peter, but do we have to wait another two years to see your next project?

FOR SALE

Austin-Healey '100' parts for sale

I have been sorting out some shelves in my garage, and have some stuff that I would like to sell. These are items collected over the years and no longer need, but maybe will help someone else restore their car or just keep it going. Prices are indicative - I'm open to reasonable offers. For the 'new unused' items I'm suggesting less than half the current AH

'100' Radiator – 'Coventry Radiators' – needs to be re-cored but otherwise complete.- \$50



Voltage Regulator new boxed (AH Spares - ELG 163) - \$40



SU Fuel Pump – single – new, boxed with bolt banjos and washers for installation. \$190



'100' grille slats - new unused - \$1,000
(These are now over \$2000 from Moss or AH Spares.)

FOR SALE

Spares prices even before adding freight and GST.

If you are interested in any of these please call or SMS me on 0403 198 343 or email me at gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

Happy Healeying
Gordon Lynas



Sealed Beam
Headlight
units RHD
Pair. - \$10



Badge Bar with mounting
pedestals, – unused – as new- \$35

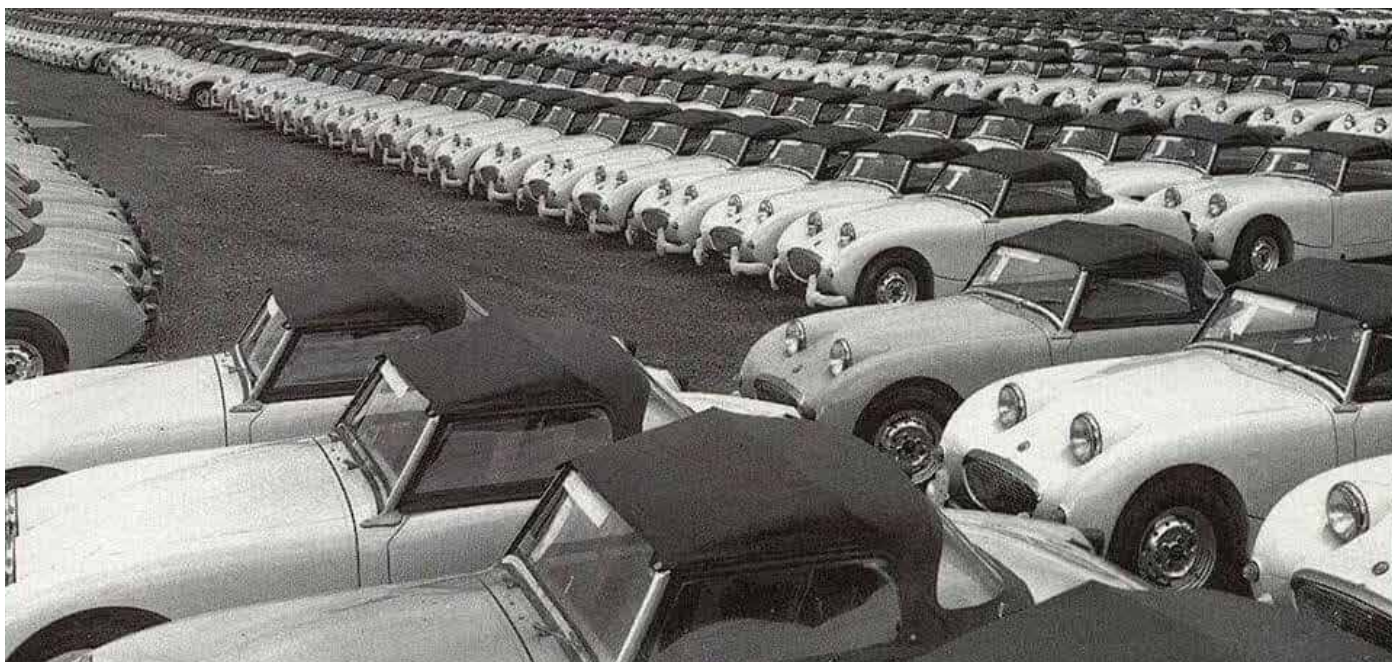


Original '100' Front bumper bar – straight, but needs stripping and re-chroming - \$50.

(I have the other overrider, if wanted)

Interested in a single 6 inch, 72 spoke chrome wire wheel with 195-15 tyre, that's in as new condition? Well John Burch has one for sale for \$350. You can contact John on 0411 195 088.

Your Last Page



Spot the Austin-Healey. Shouldn't be too hard, but can you spot the Big Healey?

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Ross Bond and the 3000 in the pre-Minilite days.



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Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm